

splunk test

Date Report Raised: 2026-08-12

Incident Period: Not specified

Classification Alert Level: Medium

Executive Summary

Splunk detected activity indicating that Microsoft Defender Antivirus real-time protection was disabled on **DESKTOP-Q1HN49.kerningcitydental.ca**. The alert confirms the security-control state change, but the supplied payload does not establish whether the change was authorised or malicious. Further endpoint and administrative telemetry should be reviewed before final disposition. The incident is assessed as **Suspicious – Further Investigation Required** with **Medium confidence**. Evidence coverage is **60.0%**.

Incident Classification

- **Incident family:** endpoint_security_control_impairment
- **Routing confidence:** High
- **Routing evidence:** Splunk detection/message indicates endpoint security protection was disabled.

Final Verdict

- **Classification:** Suspicious – Further Investigation Required
- **Confidence:** Medium
- **Source severity:** Medium

Findings

- **Detection:** KCD - Endpoint - Windows Defender Disabled
- **Splunk SID:** scheduler__mydfir__mahcyberdefense__RMD5a86f10ee55ab1051_at_1785437400_2927
- **Host:** DESKTOP-Q1HN49.kerningcitydental.ca
- **Severity:** Medium
- **Time:** 2026-07-30 18:40:59 UTC
- **Message:** Microsoft Defender Antivirus Real-time Protection scanning for malware and other potentially unwanted software was disabled.
- **Account:** Not present in supplied evidence
- **Process:** Not present in supplied evidence
- **Command line:** Not present in supplied evidence
- **Source:** Splunk

5Ws and 1H

- **Who:** The responsible user/account is not established from the supplied Splunk alert.

- **What:** Microsoft Defender Antivirus Real-time Protection scanning for malware and other potentially unwanted software was disabled.
- **When:** 2026-07-30 18:40:59 UTC
- **Where:** Host: DESKTOP-Q1HN49.kerningcitydental.ca.
- **Why:** The reason for the security-relevant state change is not established from the alert alone.
- **How:** The Splunk alert records the resulting security event/state but does not necessarily identify the process, command, user or management system that caused it.

Observed Indicators

- None extracted.

Confirmed Malicious IOCs

- None confirmed from supplied evidence.

Threat Intelligence

Provider Status

- **VirusTotal:** Provider evaluated; no supported eligible indicator was available.
- **AbuseIPDB:** Provider evaluated; no supported eligible indicator was available.
- **OTX:** Provider evaluated; no supported eligible indicator was available.

Enrichment Results

- No completed external enrichment result was available. See Provider Status above for the reason.

Interpretation note: Threat-intelligence reputation is contextual evidence only. It does not change an indicator's incident role by itself. A device public IP, for example, remains a host attribute unless separate evidence identifies it as attacker infrastructure.

MITRE ATT&CK

- **T1562.001 – Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools** (Defense Evasion) | Confidence: High

Timeline

- **2026-07-30 18:40:59 UTC** — KCD - Endpoint - Windows Defender Disabled | Source: Splunk alert JSON

Recommendations

- Confirm whether Microsoft Defender Antivirus real-time protection was intentionally disabled by an authorised administrator, management platform or approved maintenance activity.
- Review the underlying Splunk search results and source events around the alert timestamp to identify the account, process or command responsible for the configuration change.
- Review PowerShell, process-creation and command-line telemetry for Set-MpPreference, DisableRealtimeMonitoring, registry changes or other commands capable of modifying Defender settings.

- Confirm the current Microsoft Defender Antivirus, real-time protection and tamper-protection state on the affected endpoint.
- Check central endpoint-security policy/GPO/Intune configuration for an authorised policy change.
- Hunt across other endpoints for Defender or other security controls being disabled during the same period.
- If the change was unauthorised, re-enable protection and investigate the responsible account/process for follow-on malicious activity.

Investigation Scope and Evidence Boundary

SOC Augmentor analysed the supplied Splunk alert artefact only. It did not have direct access to the originating Splunk environment, historical searches, Windows Event Logs, Microsoft Defender Operational logs, Sysmon telemetry, endpoint-management records or change-management records unless those artefacts were explicitly included in the input.

- Activity before and after the alert cannot be independently queried from the supplied alert alone.
- A responsible user, process, command line or causal mechanism cannot be established unless present in the supplied evidence.
- Whether Microsoft Defender was subsequently re-enabled cannot be determined from the alert alone.
- Environment-wide scope cannot be established from a single supplied alert.
- The absence of malware, persistence, lateral movement or other activity must not be inferred unless the relevant telemetry was actually reviewed.

Evidence-state terminology: 'Not present in supplied evidence' means the required data was not contained in the artefact provided to SOC Augmentor; it does not mean the activity was searched for and not found. 'Not found during investigation' should only be used when the relevant data source was actually reviewed.

Evidence Gaps and Investigation Limitations

- Responsible account: not present in supplied evidence; additional investigation is required.
- Process: not present in supplied evidence; additional investigation is required.
- Command line: not present in supplied evidence; additional investigation is required.
- Underlying source event/context: not present in supplied evidence; additional investigation is required.

Further Investigation Required

Underlying Defender event/context

- **Why unresolved:** The alert records the detection but does not contain the surrounding Defender Operational event sequence.
- **Required investigation:** Query the affected host in Splunk for Microsoft-Windows-Windows Defender/Operational events around the alert time, including Event IDs 5001 and 5007 where available.

Pre-alert activity

- **Why unresolved:** Historical activity before the detection is outside the supplied alert payload.
- **Required investigation:** Review approximately 10–15 minutes before the alert for process creation, PowerShell, services, scheduled tasks, logons and other relevant endpoint activity.

Responsible user/process/command

- **Why unresolved:** The supplied alert does not identify the actor or mechanism responsible for the configuration change.
- **Required investigation:** Correlate Sysmon/process-creation and Windows telemetry to identify the user, process/image, command line, parent process and security context.

Protection restoration

- **Why unresolved:** The alert confirms disablement but contains no later endpoint-state evidence.
- **Required investigation:** Review subsequent Defender Operational events and/or current endpoint state to establish whether real-time protection and Tamper Protection were restored.

Environment scope

- **Why unresolved:** A single supplied alert cannot establish whether equivalent activity occurred elsewhere.
- **Required investigation:** Hunt across endpoints for equivalent Defender-disable/configuration-change events and related processes during the same period.

Tool/software reputation

- **Why unresolved:** No responsible executable or utility is identified in the original alert.
- **Required investigation:** If follow-up telemetry identifies a tool, record its path, publisher/signer, version and hash where available, then perform appropriate OSINT/threat-intelligence enrichment.

Validation / Contradiction Checks

- No major contradictions detected between retained source evidence and final classification.